Putting self-interest to work for the public good

An application of the Decentralized Curation framework

Speaker script

The handout leads the session's title and scope. This script accompanies the presentation deck. Slide numbers match the deck. Read the spoken paragraphs naturally; bracketed directions are private delivery cues. The slides supply a picture, a question or a result while the explanation comes from you.

The eighty-minute schedule matches the facilitator guide. Timing includes demonstrations, audience answers and quiet scoring time, not continuous speech. Protect the game's scoring window. If joining or recovery takes longer, shorten a later discussion explicitly rather than rush participants through an active round. The deck has 20 slides. The opening establishes the curation problem, compares approaches and introduces the general framework before applying it to public goods funding. Source links and technical answers remain in the private notes; follow-up codes are on the handout.

Use the live values on screen if a slider changes them. Default numerical checkpoints below describe the reset example only. The deck owns those inputs; the shared policy, session information, facilitator guide and source register remain the detailed references.

1. Putting self-interest to work for the public good

Target: 1 minute. Elapsed: 0:00 to 0:01.

“Today I want to start with a problem we all share: there is more information than we can personally check, yet our decisions depend on what we learn from it.

“Decentralized Curation is a proposal for organizing that work. Can we make producing, assessing and correcting useful information rewarding to the people doing it, so others can make better decisions?

“I have worked on this framework since 2021. We will define the problem, examine the proposed solution, apply it to public goods funding and then experience one part of it together.

“Thank you to Octant for sponsoring this session.”

[Let the title settle. Keep the funding application for later; first establish why anyone needs curation.]

2. Why curation matters

Target: 2 minutes. Elapsed: 0:01 to 0:03.

“Curation determines which claims and evidence inform our decisions. Individuals cannot assess every relevant claim and its supporting evidence; we depend on journals, peer review, research databases and other curators.

“These institutions influence which findings gain credibility, which questions receive attention and which contributions attract resources. Their competence and incentives therefore matter.

“Access to more information does not by itself give us reliable knowledge. We need information accurate and relevant enough for a particular decision. The foundational paper calls that decision-grade knowledge.

“Better evidence can help us compare consequences and correct mistaken beliefs. It cannot decide whose interests should count or settle every disagreement about values. Curation is one part of a decision, with real consequences for the rest.”

[Use one academic example: peer review, a systematic review or research software assessment.]

3. Information quality is not one thing

Target: 2 minutes. Elapsed: 0:03 to 0:05.

“Suppose a world-politics feed publishes perfectly accurate football trivia. The facts can be right and still fail the reader’s purpose. Accuracy and relevance answer different questions.

“Accuracy asks whether a factual claim holds under its stated scope and time. Relevance asks how much it matters for this goal, here and now. A high score for relevance does not certify the facts; a correct fact does not establish its importance.

“The paper also names timeliness, interpretability, completeness and accessibility. The important dimensions depend on the domain. Evidence makes claims and judgments inspectable; it is support for assessing quality, not a substitute for every quality we care about.

“In our funding application, we will keep factual claims separate from relevance judgments. We will also revisit relevance as circumstances change. A contribution can remain accurately described while becoming more or less important.”

[Start with accuracy and relevance, then point to the other dimensions. Do not introduce a single overall quality score.]

4. Who should curate?

Target: 2 minutes. Elapsed: 0:05 to 0:07.

“A central curator can bring expertise, a consistent editorial purpose and fast decisions. The difficulty is dependence on that curator: limited capacity, blind spots and incentives can shape what everyone else sees. We need ways to inspect and contest those judgments.

“A simple vote opens participation and tells us something about people’s preferences. Counting votes alone does not gather evidence or make every voter informed about the subject. Popularity is not the same as accuracy or relevance to a stated goal.

“These are not exhaustive descriptions of institutions. Democratic processes can include expert advice, deliberation and scrutiny; specialists can learn from the people affected by their decisions.

“The design challenge is to combine participation with informed, inspectable and correctable judgment. Opening entry is only one part of that. It does not guarantee equal influence or representation of everyone affected, and experts do not acquire the right to decide public purposes just by being experts.”

[Ask which part of the challenge a familiar system handles well. Do not frame the proposal as a proven replacement for democracy or professional expertise.]

5. A framework before a mechanism

Target: 2 minutes. Elapsed: 0:07 to 0:09.

“The foundational paper proposes four design steps.

“First, define the problem. Which decision is suffering, and is missing or poor information actually part of the cause?

“Second, identify the qualities that matter for that decision. We should not assume every domain needs the same score.

“Third, ask where challenges make sense. They help only when a claim can be falsified and finding decisive counter-evidence is feasible and cheaper than exhaustively verifying everything. A fact that anyone can check instantly may need no elaborate dispute system.

“Fourth, choose a mechanism for each quality. A factual challenge and a judgment of relevance do different jobs. We should not force them into one signal.

“Decentralized Curation is this broader framework. The paper develops news as an application. Today we will use public goods funding, with its own purpose and policy. We want credible consensus: judgments grounded in evidence, assessed under an explicit policy and open to useful correction.”

[Trace the four steps in order. Leave the funding workflow for slide 7.]

6. What should become rewarding?

Target: 3 minutes. Elapsed: 0:09 to 0:12.

“The proposal is to make useful curation personally worthwhile. That takes honesty, competence and scrutiny. Honesty means reporting sincerely; competence means knowing how to judge the subject; scrutiny means critically examining claims and evidence. An honest person can be mistaken, and an expert can report strategically or fail to investigate.

“The relevance game asks participants to report privately and makes rewards depend on how their judgments compare with others. A factual challenge gives a separate reward for exposing a false claim. These incentives aim to make honest, informed work worthwhile.

“Here is a quick illustration of shared expectations. Look at the three codes on your handout. Without talking or scanning, choose the one you think most people will choose: left, middle or right. Keep it private.

[Allow five silent seconds. Do not point out the middle code’s dark green color. This is a show of hands, with no money or app scoring.]

“Reveal together: one finger for left, two for middle, three for right. One, two, three.

[Observe the distribution. If there is no clear cluster, say: “We did not find one shared choice this time.”]

“I made the middle code green. I notice it and expect you to notice it too. A shared focal point like that is called a Schelling point. The proposal aims to make honest assessment a shared focal point, but this little game has no factual answer and does not show that the incentives achieve that aim.

“Paying for assessment does not prove that useful work happened. Investigation must be worth its effort and pay better overall than cheaply predicting the group. We need to test two links: do rewards induce useful curation, and do decisions based on it benefit the people affected?”

[The labels, position and destinations also influence choices. Do not attribute the result to color alone. If asked about future selection, losses reduce draw chances only when stake falls relative to others after replenishment.]

7. Apply the framework to public goods funding

Target: 2 minutes. Elapsed: 0:12 to 0:14.

“Let us apply those steps. Our decision is which public contributions to support. A group defines the goal, judging criteria, required evidence and assessor rewards. Together, these form its policy. A pool applies that policy to nominations.

“A person nominates work, supplies checkable claims and evidence, identifies a beneficiary and puts down a deposit backing those claims. A jury assesses relevance under the policy. People can challenge the claims, fund an appeal of a score and reassess relevance later.

“The assessment produces relative weights. A funding budget can use them to allocate support, and that budget can arrive after the curation. Funding is one use of the assessment, rather than the definition of the framework.

“The process distributes judgment and checking. It still depends on sound criteria, accessible evidence and credible arbitration. Now we will follow one example so those roles become concrete.”

[Trace funders → pool → beneficiaries first. Then show who supplies the assessment: nominators bring claims and evidence, jurors judge relevance, and fact-checkers take factual disputes to an external arbitrator. The creator publishes the policy. Continuous funding does not remove per-nomination jury and appeal rounds.]

8. Set the policy; nominate checkable work

Target: 2 minutes. Elapsed: 0:14 to 0:16.

“Our example goal is to support open infrastructure that research depends on. How much does the nominee’s completed and maintained work underpin how research is done, shared and kept, now? We consider who relies on it, its role and the alternatives, supported by evidence of use, costs and limitations.

“This is a choice for this pool. Publishing the policy makes it inspectable; it does not settle whose needs it includes or misses. Another pool may choose a different goal.

“Our nominee is NumPy, the array library used in scientific Python. Its version 2.0.0 was released on 16 June 2024. We can check that against the release record. Establishing the date does not establish how much the work matters under our criteria.

“The release record is real. This nomination, its scores and its funding are illustrative. This is not an actual application by NumPy.”

[Read the scoring question once, then point from the dated claim to the published release announcement. Ask which relevance criterion the release date alone can answer.]

Source for this example: NumPy release record. Keep the link in the notes for questions rather than projecting it.

9. Jurors score independently

Target: 2 minutes. Elapsed: 0:16 to 0:18.

“People put down a deposit to enter the draw for paid jury work. Their stake is capital they can lose. More available stake increases their chance of being drawn. Here six drawn seats are held by three jurors: more seats do not necessarily mean more independent people.

“Each juror reads the evidence and privately seals a score before revealing it. The technical name is commit and reveal. These controls show scores after revelation. The result is the weighted mean; more drawn weight gives a juror more influence.

“Watch what happens when I move one score.”

[Move one slider and pause.]

“The calculation changes predictably. To decide whether the judgment improved, we need the reason and the evidence, not just the new number.”

[Ask what evidence could justify the change. Reset the example to its starting values before advancing. Keep the limitations of sealing for slide 19.]

10. Curate the shares; distribution can follow

Target: 2 minutes. Elapsed: 0:18 to 0:20.

“Think of one whole budget being divided into shares. The table shows each contribution’s weight, its share of the total and the funding that share receives. At the reset values, NumPy has weight 0.60 out of a total of 1.50. That is a 40 percent share, not 60 percent of the budget.

“Set funding to zero: the shares remain. Add 100 units per day, and NumPy’s share receives 40.”

[Set funding to zero, then restore 100. Point to the unchanged shares and changed amounts.]

“We have curated an assessment that can exist before a funding budget. Curation itself has costs, even when beneficiary funding arrives later. These weights express judgments under this policy, not measured public benefit.”

[Ask: “If one weight rises and the budget stays fixed, whose share changes?” Take a brief answer.]

11. Contest a score through an appeal

Target: 2 minutes. Elapsed: 0:20 to 0:22.

“Suppose people think the assessment missed something important. Anyone can help fund a proposed score, including the person who nominated the work. Competing, fully funded proposals trigger a larger jury.

“Here the jury grows from six seats to twelve. It examines the same nomination and reaches its own judgment. Let us apply this illustrative result.”

[Select **Apply appeal result**. Read the result on the current slide.]

“The adopted score and funding shares change. An appeal gives people a route to contest a judgment. More seats do not automatically mean more knowledge: correction still needs evidence, independent assessment and funding.”

[Ask what evidence they would want the appeal jury to consider. Keep settlement rules in the private questions below.]

12. Challenge a factual claim

Target: 2 minutes. Elapsed: 0:22 to 0:24.

“Now take a different kind of disagreement. Imagine the nomination says: ‘NumPy 2.0.0 was released in 2020.’ The release record says 16 June 2024. That gives a fact-checker evidence for a claim challenge, not a reason to argue about the relevance score.

“Anyone can challenge a claim as false or untestable while its nomination is active. An external arbitrator decides. A successful fact-checker receives the submitter’s deposit and the nomination ends. The reward gives people a reason to look for errors, but it works only if investigation and reliable adjudication are feasible.”

[Select **Show debunked outcome**. Read the result on the current slide.]

“Future funding stops. What the nomination already earned remains owed to its beneficiary. The submitter can make a fresh nomination.

“The 2020 claim is invented for this demonstration. It is not an accusation against NumPy.”

[Ask where the reward comes from. A lack of challenges alone is not evidence that every claim was checked.]

13. Reassess when circumstances change

Target: 1 minute. Elapsed: 0:24 to 0:25.

“A contribution can remain accurately described while its relevance changes. Alternatives improve; reliance grows or shrinks. Periodic reassessment runs a fresh scoring round. An appeal contests an existing score, while reassessment asks again in the current context.

“This is a separate branch of the example. I am restoring the original nomination and applying an illustrative lower assessment.”

[Select **Apply lower assessment**.]

“The new weight changes future funding; earlier earnings stay earned. We now have three different correction paths: challenge a claim, appeal a judgment or reassess it later. Let us experience the judgment part ourselves.”

14. Join the workshop

Target: 3 minutes. Elapsed: 0:25 to 0:28.

“Scan the code or open the room address. Use an alias and take a seat. You do not need an account or wallet; we are using points.

“Every round gives each seat the same weight, regardless of earlier wins or losses. This exercise lets us examine scoring incentives; it cannot test whether stake losses select better jurors.

“Your alias, revealed scores and standings will be visible to this room. Some rounds may give you an optional adversarial role. You can decline that role, sit out a nominee or simply observe. Please ask people before photographing or sharing identifiable results.

“I will wipe the room records after our discussion. The room does not automatically expire, and that wipe does not remove credentials or sealed-score proofs stored on your own device.

“Keep your device awake when we reveal. For now, read the policy before taking your first scoring decision.”

[Compare seats with participants. Remove duplicate or stray seats before opening the first nominee. Do not put private host controls on the projector.]

15. Use one shared policy

Target: 2 minutes. Elapsed: 0:28 to 0:30.

“Our question is the same one from the example: how much does this nominee’s completed and maintained work underpin how research is done, shared and kept, now?

“Consider reliance, its role in research and available alternatives. Keep your personal taste, your own field and who runs or funds the project separate from that assessment. A completed contribution can still matter greatly today.

“Score the work actually nominated. If two nominations claim the same underlying work, we should not credit that same work twice. Distinct contributions by the same beneficiary can still count separately.

“The anchors give us a common language, not measured truths. We are using short descriptions and our prior knowledge today, without a common evidence dossier. You may sit out if you lack enough information, or for any other reason. This is an exercise in how judgment and incentives interact, not a rigorous evaluation of these projects.”

[Read the anchor labels together. Invite one clarification about the policy. Avoid announcing which nominee should score highest.]

16. See what the workshop rewards

Target: 2 minutes. Elapsed: 0:30 to 0:32.

“The scores we submit produce a group result. Around it is a reward zone. Every seat counts equally in this workshop.

“Inside that zone, scores closer to the group result receive a larger share of the points. Outside it, scores lose points, with larger losses further away. If everyone gives the same score, there are no distance penalties.

“Watch the reward zone when I move one score.”

[Move a dot, then reset. Let the audience describe what changed.]

“Your score helps shape the result against which you and everyone else are rewarded. That can draw attention to the shared question; it can also reward a shared mistake.

“Relevance scores guide support for contributions; juror rewards pay the people assessing them. This workshop uses points to let us experience those incentives.”

17. Play the jury

Target: 27 minutes. Elapsed: 0:32 to 0:59.

“For each nominee, read the description, apply the policy and seal your own score. Keep the two secret words used to seal your score private. When I close scoring, keep this page open so your device can reveal. You can change your seal before closing, or sit the nominee out.

“Before opening each round, I will announce the grading cutoff and leave time for sleeping phones to reconnect and reveal. Once I grade, a later reveal cannot change that round’s result.”

[Play the six default nominees in the order shown by the room. Allow roughly four and a half minutes each: quiet scoring first, then recovery and grading, followed by ninety seconds of discussion. Do not shorten an active scoring window.]

After each result, ask:

“Which piece of evidence or part of the policy most affected your score?”

[Hear one higher and one lower assessment when time permits. Then point to the outcome.]

“What did this rule reward in the reports we actually received?”

[Do not call paid jurors correct or forfeiting jurors incompetent. Record interesting differences for the debrief instead of resolving every one now. Do not announce the privately recorded comparison before all the compared rounds finish.]

If proof reporting needs explanation, say:

“A sealed-score proof contains the score and its two words. Another seated juror can report a valid proof during scoring for a bounty; the disclosing juror loses points. This concerns disclosing the proof, not discussing the policy.”

[For the assigned-role round, let the interface deliver the private instruction. Participants may decline it. Do not identify roles publicly before the result. If nobody reveals, explain that the round is void; do not infer a judgment from it.]

18. What shaped the scores?

Target: 5 minutes. Elapsed: 0:59 to 1:04.

“Now let us interpret what happened. Where did the policy guide us, and where did expectations about other people guide us? What evidence explained a high score or a low one? Did we disagree about the facts, the policy’s scope, or the available alternatives?”

[Hear two or three explanations. Reveal the privately recorded comparison now, including any mismatch with the observed results.]

“The group result and spread describe these reports, without explaining them. Scores near zero or one have less room to vary. A wider reward zone alone does not establish deeper disagreement.

“In the assigned-role round, compare the people assigned a role, the scores actually submitted and the points actually earned. Being assigned a role is not the same as following it. Following an instruction is not evidence that money caused manipulation. A matching score does not tell us someone’s motive.

“Let us use the widget to examine how a coordinated group can move the group result.”

[Move the bloc control gradually. State the displayed configuration; do not announce a universal safe percentage.]

“The group can sometimes move the result against which everyone is rewarded. A minority can also have a good argument and lose. This is why coherence alone cannot certify accuracy. One room and one simulated group do not establish resistance to capture.”

19. Attack the mechanism

Target: 5 minutes. Elapsed: 1:04 to 1:09.

“Now let us examine where the defenses could fail.

“A published policy gives us shared criteria, but the criteria can still be ambiguous or misguided.

“Private scoring makes copying harder while scores remain hidden. Early disclosure exposes a score before others finish. Sealing does not prevent people from coordinating privately or buying votes.

“Deposits put a juror’s money at risk, but concentrated stake can still concentrate influence. A large deposit alone does not demonstrate competence.

“An appeal allows another hearing, but it needs funding and useful evidence. A larger jury can still share the same bias.

“This workshop adds a penalty and reward for reporting proof of a disclosed score. That particular rule belongs to this exercise. A vote buyer may have other ways to check compliance.

“Choose one of these attacks. What would the attacker do, and what would the defense need to stop it?”

[Use the remaining time for one concrete attack and response. Ask what weakness remains. Keep contract comparisons, payout rules and recovery machinery in the private notes.]

20. Close the loop

Target: 11 minutes. Elapsed: 1:09 to 1:20.

“We began with a problem: our decisions depend on information that we cannot all inspect for ourselves. The proposal is open participation supported by honesty, competence and scrutiny. Personal rewards should make useful curation worthwhile for the people doing it, while their assessments help others make better decisions.

“We explored public-goods curation, with funding as one use of its results. What would make this useful in your work, and what would make you hesitate to rely on it?”

[Use about two minutes for the recap and first responses. Keep the remaining time conversational.]

[From 1:11 to 1:18, invite questions. If the room is quiet, choose one prompt at a time:]

- [“What is the difference between challenging a claim, appealing a score and reassessing later?” Ask a participant to explain before adding anything.]
- [“Where would informed judgment make a difference in your work? What evidence would those jurors need?”]
- [“What would show us that the rewards improved judgment, rather than simply producing agreement?”]
- [“Who would benefit from the resulting decisions? Whose needs might our criteria miss?”]

[Use a concrete example from the audience. Keep detailed mechanism questions brief and offer the private source notes for follow-up. Do not fill the time with a second lecture.]

[At about 1:18, bring the discussion back to the central idea.]

“We need two separate results: rewards must make useful investigation worth doing, and the decisions must improve outcomes for the people affected. Agreement and profit alone establish neither.

“Your handout has the codes to read the framework preprint and stay in touch. Please bring me both use cases and counterexamples. Thank you.”

[Leave the closing slide visible for questions and point people to the handout codes. Finish the game if necessary so final standings remain available. After the discussion, wipe room records as promised and verify that the wipe succeeded.]

Private reference: source scope

Use these notes for source questions; there is no corresponding projected slide.

“The sources have different roles. The opening four-step framework, multidimensional account of information quality and incentive hypothesis come from the published paper, which records the research at a particular release. The source register identifies later working choices. The inspected implementation snapshot supports statements about that code, not a claim that those contracts are deployed, audited or identical to the paper.

“The Arrow proposal supports the experiment’s stated scope. It does not supply results. Some implementation and proposal sources are access-controlled, so the public explanation states what was inspected and where independent access is limited.

“If a source seems to contradict today’s explanation, first check which version and which system it describes.”

References: published version 1.2.0, published manuscript source, Schelling point explanation, inspected implementation snapshot, Arrow experiment proposal, public mechanism summary, full source register, proposed evaluation plan.

Private reference: questions to answer without loading the slides

These are optional answers, not another presentation segment. The source register retains the detailed rules and their evidence boundaries.

How do the funding weights and juror rewards differ?

“The example’s funding weight is the smaller of the requested cap and the adopted relevance score. The cap is a ceiling, not a promised share. Normalize the eligible positive weights to obtain the shares. One positive weight receives the whole share; no positive weights means there is no allocation yet.

“A jury-issued relevance score is a weighted mean. An unopposed funded proposal can instead supply an adopted score by forfeiture, without another jury. Juror rewards are a separate calculation. The workshop’s group result is a mean and its reward zone uses standard deviation, with a zero-spread fallback. The inspected implementation instead grades reports against the final jury’s weighted median and median absolute deviation, with a configured floor.

“In the intended working design, ether (ETH) pays a fixed service fee per eligible revealed seat when a valid ruling is issued. A separate utility token provides jury stake and the redistribution of incoherence penalties. If nobody loses utility tokens, there are no extra tokens to redistribute. The service fee is separate from that coherence result.”

See the grading comparison for the model and version boundaries.

What does score sealing protect, and where does it fall short?

“Sealing binds a later revealed score to its earlier commitment. The inspected contract permits an early reveal while other people can still commit, so it does not fully prevent copying. Private coordination, bribery and other ways to prove compliance remain possible. The workshop’s proof-reporting penalty is an exercise rule; no corresponding reporting path was found in that inspected contract snapshot.”

Is there an authority that can stop funding?

“The inspected funding implementation has a configured, time-limited authority that can permanently stop future accrual once. That holder cannot take funding already accrued. This is an implementation-specific governance choice, not a claim that such authority follows from the framework.”

How do public appeal positions settle?

“Anyone can back a score position, including the nominator and a juror. A backer can still serve if selected under the ordinary draw. The same numeric score against the same ruling has one shared position. Proposals use steps of 0.01 from zero to one; the final jury score keeps its own precision.

“Admission stays open for a bounded period. All admitted positions then share a funding deadline. Two fast funders cannot close admission early. Underfunded positions receive full refunds. If no position fully funds, the referenced ruling stands. One funded position wins by forfeiture; at least two funded distinct positions share a larger jury.

“Each contested level has one combined pot. It covers the jury-fee shortfall after the pool contribution. The net pot is divided by inverse distance to the ultimate final score; a unique exact prediction receives the whole net pot. Each position then pays its backers pro rata. A closer prediction can still lose money after fees and competition.

“Adjudicated backer pots wait until the whole appeal chain ends, and every level uses its ultimate final score. That lock is different from already-earned jury fees and beneficiary earnings.”

What if the jury fails to reach quorum?

“The intended threshold is valid, timely reveals covering at least 80 percent of the originally drawn voting weight. Missing reports do not make the denominator smaller, and there is no separate minimum headcount. A failed appeal attempt retries at the same planned size, without a fee for the failed attempt. Retries have no fixed limit while that protected appeal process remains eligible. A later appeal level doubles the previous ruling’s planned target; a retry does not double it again.”

Why does a numerical score not solve the judgment problem?

“The score records an assessment under a policy and supplies an input to a chosen allocation rule. It is not an objective unit of research quality or public benefit. The questions remain: does the policy ask for something worthwhile, is the evidence adequate, do assessors apply it well, and do the consequences help affected people?”

What happens to earned funds, holds and exits?

“Only new nominations face holdback before earning. A later score increase or decrease creates no new holdback and changes future earning when adopted under the ordinary finalization rules. Once beneficiary funding is earned, it is immediately

claimable, including during a claim challenge and after the nomination is debunked. A successful challenge closes the nomination, stops future earning and awards the submitter's deposit to the fact-checker. It does not take the beneficiary's past earnings.

"A request to withdraw the nomination is a different event. If made after a factual dispute starts, it waits behind that dispute. A successful challenge closes the nomination and cancels that queued exit. A rejected challenge allows the exit to proceed under the ordinary rules."

What if the nomination is edited?

"A jury and its appeals remain attached to the revision they assessed. Editing does not erase that funded contest or transfer its judgment to new content. A new revision needs its own adopted score for score-dependent funding. Previously earned money stays attributed to the earlier revision and remains claimable. Content identifiers establish which revision is being judged; they do not guarantee that its evidence stays available."

How do honesty, competence and scrutiny differ?

"Honesty means reporting sincerely. Competence means knowing how to judge the subject. Scrutiny means critically examining claims and evidence, including plausible alternatives. Willingness to examine a claim is different from having the expertise to assess it; an expert can also accept a claim without questioning it.

"Fees compensate service, not measured effort or expertise. Rewards and penalties aim to make informed judgment and critical scrutiny worthwhile. Private reports and agreement-based rewards are meant to make honesty a shared focal point, or Schelling point. The absence of collusion does not establish that truthful reporting is the only equilibrium or the most profitable strategy.

"Competence selection requires informed investigation to be profitable after effort and other costs, and to outperform a cheap prediction of the group's answer. A participant can predict others accurately without understanding the subject. Service fees can also outweigh token losses. Compare total returns, including both assets and effort, rather than treating agreement or a loss as a competence test.

"Losses reduce future draw chances only if available stake falls relative to competitors. Replenishment, outside wealth and changes in other jurors' stakes can change that outcome. The design does not guarantee that every weak assessor leaves."

What can we infer from the handout's coordination game?

"It can illustrate shared expectations and a salient choice. It cannot isolate a color effect: color, middle position, label and destination occur together. It also cannot establish that honesty is a focal point in an assessment game, because this choice has no factual answer and asks people to coordinate. A cluster is an observation about this room, not proof of the proposed incentives."

What can we infer from the points exercise?

"We can observe which reports earn points under this rule and discuss why participants chose them. The same reports produce the group result and its rewards, so the rewards do not independently establish honesty, competence and scrutiny. Even unanimous erroneous scores can earn rewards.

"The exercise gives each seat equal weight every round; accumulated point losses do not reduce later weight or draw chances. It does not model real capital at risk, costly information gathering, replenishment or stake-based selection. The short descriptions and prior knowledge also differ from a full evidence dossier.

"An assigned role is an instruction, not evidence that money caused manipulation. Discussion can affect later scores, and six different nominees are not six independent replications. Treat the results as observations for discussion, not a causal test of the complete design."

Does open participation mean that everyone is represented?

"No. People may lack money, time, relevant knowledge or access, and more deposited stake can carry more influence. Open entry removes an invitation requirement; it does not guarantee equal influence or representation of everyone affected.

"Choosing goals, judging evidence and representing affected people's needs are different tasks. Democratic institutions can include expert advice and deliberation. This design is one proposed way to organize assessment, not proof that it replaces or improves upon democratic decision-making."

Where does trust remain?

"The design distributes assessment and makes some judgments contestable. It still depends on the chosen criteria, accessible evidence, an external arbitrator and the implementation of its rules. We should ask what supports each dependency rather than describe the whole process as needing no trust."

What would establish public benefit?

“First test whether the incentives improve assessment compared with a feasible alternative, using evidence of quality independent of the reward formula. Then test whether decisions based on that assessment improve outcomes for affected people, including costs, excluded needs and harms. Better prediction of the group, stable scores, private profit and faithful application of a policy do not by themselves establish that second result.”

Does this guarantee honest or sound judgment?

“No such guarantee has been established. The design tries to make useful assessment and correction worthwhile. Shared bias, coordination, poor policy and inaccessible evidence can still produce a bad outcome. We need separate evidence about reporting behavior, assessment quality, correction and downstream consequences. Profit and agreement alone do not supply it.”

What makes capture costly, and can the community recover?

“Acquiring enough of a dedicated utility token may be costly, and a visible capture may damage demand for the system and that token. Neither effect is a fixed security guarantee: liquidity, concentration, attacker motives and public recognition matter.

“The intended recovery path is voluntary forking. A group can choose whom to exclude and preserve the other balances; funders can choose whether to migrate their funds. Different groups may disagree about suspicion or which fork to follow. The practical requirements include a usable snapshot, migration tools and coordination. The capture and recovery discussion records the attribution and the limits of this response.”

What do these materials establish today?

“There is a research proposal, formal and simulated analysis with explicit limits, inspected implementation evidence, a proposed precursor experiment and a functioning teaching exercise. They do not yet establish that the integrated permissionless system reliably improves public outcomes. That is the work to test.”